

FAQs

Help me with my help files

Q. I use Windows XP with SP1. I am unable to use the Help files from any program in my PC. I tried opening the *.chm help files but I get an error that the file cannot be found, even though it is present.

Nitesh Kisan Raut

A. The problem lies within your Windows setup. The file winhlp32.exe is probably corrupt. There might also be corrupt Internet Explorer files present. So, update your Internet Explorer or simply rerun the setup available from Microsoft's site at http://download.microsoft.com/download/ie6sp1/finrel/6_sp1/W98NT42KMeXP/EN-US/ie6setup.exe. This will replace winhlp32.exe, and the corresponding files necessary to run the *.chm help files.

Unidentifiable files

Q. In the recent past, I have found that many *.gid files are being created in my computer. What are these files for? I hope they are not related to any virus. I use a Celeron 300A processor with 128 MB RAM, running Windows 98.

Rakesh

A. There is no need to be alarmed. These files are created every time you use any of the Help files available within Windows, generally as *.hlp or *.chm

files. These *.gid files are nothing but pointers used by the above programs for faster searches and sorting of Help databases.

Yes, you can safely delete them. However, the .gid file will be re-built by the original Help file, the next time you access it. Also, some Windows programs require the .gid file to be present, so it's better to let sleeping dogs lie.

Watching TV

Q. I have an Athlon XP 2000+ with 128 MB RAM, 40 GB hard drive and an ASUS A7N266-VM motherboard with onboard VGA and sound. The operating systems installed are Windows 98 and Mandrake. I have a Pinnacle PCTV which works fine in Windows 98. How do I watch TV in Linux? There are no Linux drivers bundled on the driver CD, or found on the Pinnacle Web site.

Avninder Singh

A. The Pinnacle PCTV card can be used in Linux, using the BT878 TV chipset support. This should be available as the bttv kernel module. The application you need to use is called xawtv. Try running xawtv from the command line to see if you have it installed. If not, download an appropriate package for Mandrake from <http://rpms.mandrakeclub.com/rpms/mandrake-devel/cooker/i586/Mandrake/RPMS/xawtv-3.88-1mdk.i586.html>.

Unfortunately I have forgotten the password. How can I recover it?

Rana Basu

A. There are many recovery software available on the Internet that you can use. MSOfPass97 and Advanced Office 97 Password Recovery 1.33 are a few of the most popular ones. MSOfPass97 is available at <http://www.lostpassword.com/msofpass97.htm>, while Advanced Office 97 Password Recovery 1.33 can be downloaded from http://www.softpile.com/Utilities/Password_Recovery/Download_00557_1.html.

Corrupted C

Q. Every time I try to boot into my machine, it shows the error, 'Unable to read drive. Abort, Retry or Fail?' I used a Startup disk, and booted into the DOS mode successfully. Now the data in drive D is safe, but drive C is corrupted.

I used some data recovery utilities that were bundled in the Digit CD, however, I can see only unreadable characters instead of filenames.

Arvind Singh

A. This error appears because the File Allocation Table (FAT) of your C drive has been corrupted, or the hard drive itself has gone bad. Firstly, you can try diagnosing the problem with the hard drive. You will require a Norton Disk Doctor floppy disk, or CD-ROM for this. Boot the computer using the Norton CD or a Windows 98 boot disk, or a Windows 98 CD. If you boot via a Windows bootable, then choose the option to start the computer with CD-ROM support. Type 'NU' to start the Norton Utilities Program. Once you get to the menu, select 'Disk Doctor' and again press [Enter]. Choose 'Diagnose Disk', select C: and press [Enter] once more. In the event that Norton is unable to revive your computer, you can try recovering the data from the hard drive, and formatting and reloading the OS on the hard drive. You can use programs such as Stellar Data Shield or Easy Recovery Pro to recover the data.

Shutdown shortcut

Q. How can I create a shortcut icon to shutdown my computer?

Abhishek Srivastav

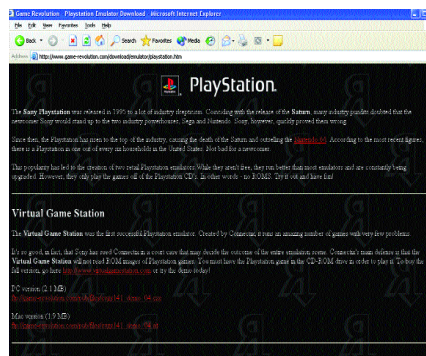
A. To create a shutdown shortcut, right-click on the desktop and go to **New > Shortcut**. Then type 'c:\windows\rundll.exe user.exe,exitwindows' as the command line—make sure you keep the spacing the same. Give the shortcut a name, such as Quick Shutdown and press Finish.

PC PlayStation

Q. I have an Intel Pentium 4 system with Windows 98 SE. I have some PlayStation CDs that do not run on it. How can I run them on my machine?

Rajeev Handa

A. You can get the CDs to run by using a PlayStation emulator that can be



You can download the PlayStation emulator to run PlayStation CDs

obtained at <http://www.game-revolution.com/download/emulator/playstation.htm>.

Lost word

Q. I have Office 97 installed on my PC. Recently I password protected both the read and modification options of a file.



Send your computing problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, TTC Industrial Area, MIDC, MIDC, Nerul, Navi Mumbai-400 706, and we may answer it here!